JUNIOR SCHOOL LEARNING HUB

GRADE 9
CHRISTIAN RELIGIOUS EDUCATION (CRE)

DETAILED FULL-YEAR LEARNER NOTES | TERMS 1, 2 AND 3

CBC-aligned teacher-prepared learning resource

These notes support the study of Christian Religious Education through Bible reading, reflection, discussion, application and service. Read the Bible passages in the translation approved by your school or church. The explanations are learning aids; learners should distinguish the biblical text from classroom interpretation and personal reflection.

How to study CRE

- Read the Bible passage in its context. Identify who is speaking, the audience, the situation and the main message.
- Use evidence from the passage when explaining an answer. Avoid relying only on memory or unsupported opinions.
- Relate Christian teachings to everyday decisions while respecting people who hold different beliefs.
- Keep a reflection journal with the passage, key lesson, personal response and one practical action.
- Participate respectfully in discussion, prayer, service and other activities according to school guidance.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Creation	The Christian belief that God is the source of the universe and life.
Stewardship	Responsible care and use of what has been entrusted to people.
Covenant	A solemn relationship or agreement; in the Bible, God establishes covenants with people.
Prophet	A person called to communicate God's message and call people to faithfulness and justice.
Disciple	A learner or follower who commits to the teaching and way of a teacher.
Parable	A short story used to communicate a moral or spiritual lesson.
Repentance	Turning away from wrongdoing and turning towards God and what is right.
Church	The Christian community of believers; also used

	for a place of worship.
Pentecost	The event in Acts 2 when the Holy Spirit came upon Jesus' followers.
Spiritual gifts	Abilities or forms of service understood by Christians as given by the Holy Spirit for the good of the community.
Courtship	A purposeful process through which people consider a relationship with a view to marriage.
Responsible parenthood	Caring for children and family needs with love, responsibility and commitment.

STRAND 1: CREATION

1. Work as a gift and responsibility

Key Bible reading: Genesis 1:26–31; Genesis 2:8–15; Colossians 3:23–24

The Bible presents work as part of human responsibility and participation in caring for creation. Work includes paid employment, farming, learning, caring for family, serving others and developing useful skills. Work can provide for needs, build character and contribute to community wellbeing. Christian teaching encourages diligence, honesty, fairness and respect for workers.

- Work should be done honestly and responsibly, not through exploitation or deception.
- People have different abilities and occupations; every lawful and useful contribution deserves respect.
- Rest is also important. A healthy pattern balances work, rest, worship, relationships and recreation.
- Stewardship means using resources carefully and avoiding waste.
- Examples of responsible work include completing school duties, caring for the environment, helping at home and serving the community.

Think and apply: How can a learner demonstrate diligence and honesty in school work and household responsibilities?

2. Christian moral values

Key Bible reading: Galatians 5:22–23; Micah 6:8; Matthew 5:1–12; 1 Corinthians 13:4–7

Christian moral values are principles that guide believers towards conduct that reflects love of God and neighbour. The Bible teaches values such as love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control. Values are shown through actions, especially when a person faces pressure or conflict.

- Love means seeking another person's good; it is not permission to accept abuse or harmful behaviour.
- Honesty involves telling the truth and acting without cheating or fraud.
- Justice means treating people fairly and protecting the dignity and rights of others.
- Forgiveness means choosing not to seek revenge; reconciliation may also require truth, accountability and changed behaviour.
- Self-control helps a person pause, consider consequences and choose a responsible response.
- Humility recognises that every person has worth and that one can learn from others.

Think and apply: Choose one value and describe a real situation in which practising it could improve relationships in school.

STRAND 2: THE BIBLE

3. Kings David and Solomon

Key Bible reading: 1 Samuel 16:1–13; 2 Samuel 5:1–5; 2 Samuel 7:8–16; 1 Kings 3:3–15; 1 Kings 8:22–30; 1 Kings 11:1–13

David became king after being anointed by Samuel. The biblical account describes his leadership, faith, courage, relationship with God and serious failures. His story teaches that leadership requires responsibility and that wrongdoing has consequences. Solomon, David's son, became king and is remembered for asking God for wisdom, building the temple in Jerusalem and developing the kingdom. The account also describes his later unfaithfulness and the consequences for the kingdom.

- David's anointing teaches that outward appearance is not the only measure of a person's suitability for responsibility.
- David's encounter with Goliath (1 Samuel 17) highlights courage and trust in God; it should not be used to encourage reckless behaviour.
- David's wrongdoing involving Bathsheba and Uriah (2 Samuel 11–12) shows the harm caused by misuse of power and the need for accountability.
- Solomon's request for wisdom (1 Kings 3) highlights the importance of discernment and serving people fairly.
- The temple was a central place of worship in Israel; Solomon's prayer at its dedication emphasised God's greatness.
- Solomon's later choices are presented as a warning about divided loyalty and the consequences of unwise leadership.

Think and apply: What qualities should a responsible leader demonstrate, and what can communities do when leaders misuse power?

4. Jesus raises the widow's son at Nain

Key Bible reading: Luke 7:11–17

Jesus meets a funeral procession at Nain. The deceased is the only son of a widow. Jesus is moved with compassion, tells the woman not to weep, touches the bier and commands the young man to rise. The young man sits up and speaks, and Jesus gives him back to his mother. The crowd responds with awe and praises God.

- Compassion means noticing suffering and responding with care rather than indifference.
- The widow's situation highlights vulnerability and the social and economic challenges faced by people without close family support in that context.
- The account presents Jesus as having authority over life and death.
- The crowd's response shows how the event strengthened recognition of God's work among the people.
- Christian application includes supporting grieving people, caring for vulnerable families and offering practical help.

Think and apply: Identify two practical ways a school community can support a learner or family experiencing bereavement.

5. Jesus heals ten people with leprosy

Key Bible reading: Luke 17:11–19

Ten people with a serious skin condition call out to Jesus for mercy. Jesus instructs them to go and show themselves to the priests. As they go, they are cleansed. One, a Samaritan, returns praising God and thanking Jesus. Jesus asks about the other nine and commends the one who returned.

- The account emphasises faith, obedience, healing and gratitude.
- The social isolation associated with the condition in the biblical setting helps explain why healing also meant restored participation in community life.
- The Samaritan's return challenges readers to recognise and express gratitude.
- Gratitude should be expressed through words and actions, not only when a person receives something large.
- People living with illness or disability should be treated with dignity; illness must not be used as a reason for stigma.

Think and apply: Why is gratitude important? Give examples of how to show appreciation at home and school.

6. The parable of the friend at midnight

Key Bible reading: Luke 11:5–13

Jesus tells of a person who goes to a friend at midnight to ask for bread for a visitor. The friend initially resists because the household is already in bed, but the request is eventually met. Jesus uses the story to teach persistence in prayer and then encourages asking, seeking and knocking. The passage also speaks of God's willingness to give good gifts.

- A parable uses an everyday situation to communicate a deeper lesson.
- Persistence means continuing with sincere effort rather than giving up quickly.
- Prayer involves speaking and listening to God; it is not a way to manipulate God or demand every personal wish.
- Christians may pray for guidance, forgiveness, strength, others' needs and the ability to act rightly.
- Prayer should be accompanied by responsible action where action is possible.

Think and apply: How can persistence help a learner when facing a difficult task, and how is persistence different from refusing to listen to advice?

7. Jesus and Nicodemus

Key Bible reading: John 3:1–21

Nicodemus, a Pharisee and Jewish leader, visits Jesus at night. Jesus teaches him about being born again or born from above, using the image of birth by water and the Spirit. Nicodemus struggles to understand the teaching. Jesus explains God's love for the world and the call to believe in him. The passage contrasts light and darkness and invites people to live truthfully.

- Nicodemus approaches Jesus with questions, showing the importance of seeking understanding.
- Being born again is presented as a spiritual transformation, not a second physical birth.

- The imagery of light points to truth and life; darkness can symbolise wrongdoing or avoidance of truth.
- John 3:16 expresses God's love and the offer of eternal life through belief in Jesus.
- Faith should influence conduct, including honesty, love, justice and care for others.

Think and apply: Why is it important to ask questions when learning about faith, and how can a person's actions show commitment to truth?

8. Jesus' ministry in Jerusalem

Key Bible reading: Selected readings: Mark 11:1–11; Mark 11:15–19; Mark 12:28–34; Mark 14–15; Luke 19:41–48; John 13:1–17

Jesus' final ministry in Jerusalem includes his entry into the city, teaching in the temple, challenges to misuse of religious authority, teaching about love of God and neighbour, the Last Supper, arrest, trial and crucifixion. The Gospel accounts present these events as central to Christian understanding of Jesus' mission.

- The entry into Jerusalem is associated with Jesus being welcomed by crowds; Christians remember it on Palm Sunday.
- Jesus challenges the misuse of the temple and calls for worship that honours God.
- The greatest commandments summarise love for God and love for neighbour.
- At the Last Supper, Jesus shares a meal with his disciples and teaches service through washing their feet.
- The arrest and trial show the opposition and suffering Jesus faced.
- Christians understand the crucifixion as central to salvation; the accounts also challenge believers to consider sacrifice, forgiveness and justice.

Think and apply: What does Jesus' example of serving others teach about leadership and the treatment of people?

9. The early Church

Key Bible reading: Acts 1:6–11; Acts 2:1–47; Acts 4:32–37; Acts 6:1–7

After Jesus' resurrection and ascension, his followers gather in Jerusalem. At Pentecost, the Holy Spirit comes upon them and they speak in languages understood by people from different places. Peter addresses the crowd and many respond to the message. The early believers meet, learn from the apostles, share fellowship, pray and support those in need.

- Pentecost is associated with the coming of the Holy Spirit and the public beginning of the Church's mission.
- The believers' shared life included teaching, fellowship, breaking bread and prayer.
- Sharing resources helped address needs within the community.
- As the community grew, practical challenges arose; the appointment of people to assist with distribution shows the importance of fair organisation.
- The early Church spread the Christian message beyond its original setting.

Think and apply: What practical steps can a community take to ensure that vulnerable members are not ignored?

10. Gifts of the Holy Spirit

Key Bible reading: 1 Corinthians 12:4–11; Romans 12:4–8; Ephesians 4:11–13; Galatians 5:22–23

The New Testament describes different gifts and forms of service within the Christian community. Gifts are diverse, but Christians are taught that they come from the same Spirit and should be used for the common good. The fruit of the Spirit describes qualities that should shape Christian character.

- Examples listed in 1 Corinthians 12 include wisdom, knowledge, faith, healing, miraculous powers, prophecy, discernment, tongues and interpretation of tongues.
- Romans 12 describes forms of service such as teaching, encouragement, giving, leadership and showing mercy.
- Spiritual gifts are not a reason for pride or competition; they should build up the community.
- Galatians 5:22–23 lists love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control as fruit of the Spirit.
- People may use their abilities in different ways: teaching, caring, organising, listening, helping, creating and serving.

Think and apply: Identify an ability you can use to benefit others. How can you use it without seeking praise or superiority?

STRAND 3: LIFE AND MINISTRY OF JESUS CHRIST

The Grade 9 design includes accounts of Jesus' healing, teaching, relationship with people and ministry. The passages in this strand invite learners to examine Jesus' compassion, authority, prayer, faith and example of service. Study each narrative carefully, noting the people involved, the need or problem, Jesus' response and the lesson for Christian living.

When studying a Gospel story, use this four-part reading method:

1. Context: What happened before and after the event?
2. Observation: Who is present, what do they say and what actions take place?
3. Meaning: What does the passage reveal about Jesus and God's purpose?
4. Application: What responsible response does the passage encourage today?

STRAND 4: THE CHURCH

The Church is understood by Christians as a community of believers called to worship, learn, serve, witness and support one another. Its activities include prayer, teaching, fellowship, care for people in need, evangelism and community service. The Church includes people with different abilities and responsibilities.

11. The Church's identity and mission

Key Bible reading: Acts 2:42–47; Matthew 28:16–20; 1 Corinthians 12:12–27

The Church is described using images such as the body of Christ and the community of believers. Just as different parts of a body have different functions, members of a church contribute in different ways. The mission of the Church includes making disciples, teaching, worshipping, serving and showing love.

- Worship expresses honour, praise, prayer and thanksgiving to God.

- Teaching helps believers understand Scripture and apply Christian principles.
- Fellowship builds belonging, encouragement and mutual responsibility.
- Service responds to human needs through practical action.
- Mission and witness involve sharing Christian faith through words and conduct.
- Church members should value one another and avoid discrimination or the misuse of authority.

Think and apply: How can a learner contribute to a caring and inclusive community, whether inside or outside church?

STRAND 5: CHRISTIAN LIVING TODAY

12. Courtship and marriage

Key Bible reading: Genesis 2:18–25; 1 Corinthians 13:4–7; Ephesians 5:21–33; Hebrews 13:4

Christian teaching presents marriage as a serious covenant relationship involving love, faithfulness, mutual respect, commitment and responsibility. Courtship is a purposeful process in which people consider compatibility, values, expectations and readiness. Grade 9 learners should understand these ideas in an age-appropriate way, recognising that they are still developing and should seek guidance from trusted adults.

- Healthy relationships are based on respect, honesty, trust, communication and appropriate boundaries.
- Consent must be freely given, informed and reversible; pressure, threats, manipulation and coercion are not acceptable.
- People should never be forced into a relationship or marriage. Child marriage and exploitation harm children's rights, safety and development.
- Marriage involves responsibilities and should not be entered into lightly or under pressure.
- Conflict should be addressed through respectful communication; violence and abuse are never acceptable.
- Young people should speak to a trusted parent, guardian, teacher or safeguarding professional when facing pressure or unsafe situations.

Think and apply: What signs show that a relationship is respectful and safe? What should a learner do if pressured into an unwanted relationship?

13. Responsible parenthood

Key Bible reading: Psalm 127:3–5; Proverbs 22:6; Ephesians 6:1–4; 1 Timothy 5:8

Responsible parenthood means providing care, protection, guidance and support for children. It includes meeting physical, emotional, educational, social and spiritual needs. Parents and guardians have responsibilities to protect children's dignity, safety and development. Communities also have a role in supporting families and safeguarding children.

- Children need food, shelter, clothing, healthcare, education, love, guidance and protection.
- Parents and guardians should provide discipline that teaches responsibility without violence, humiliation or abuse.
- Good parenting includes listening to children, setting appropriate boundaries and being a positive example.

- Caregiving is shared through family and community support, but adults remain responsible for children's safety.
- Children should know how to seek help from trusted adults if they experience neglect, abuse or exploitation.

Think and apply: List practical ways schools and communities can support children and caregivers.

14. Leisure, recreation and Christian living

Key Bible reading: Ecclesiastes 3:1–8; Mark 6:30–32; 1 Corinthians 10:31

Leisure is time used for rest, recreation and activities outside required work. Recreation can refresh the body and mind, develop talents, strengthen friendships and build community. Christian teaching encourages people to use time wisely and choose activities that promote wellbeing and respect.

- Healthy leisure includes reading, games, sport, music, creative work, nature activities and time with family.
- Rest supports health and helps prevent exhaustion.
- Activities should be safe, lawful, balanced and respectful of other people's rights.
- Excessive screen use, harmful content, gambling, substance misuse and dangerous peer pressure can negatively affect wellbeing.
- Planning time helps learners balance study, chores, worship, rest and recreation.

Think and apply: Develop a balanced weekly plan that includes study, responsibilities, rest, recreation and family time.

15. Wealth, money and poverty

Key Bible reading: Proverbs 10:4; Proverbs 22:1–2; Luke 12:13–21; Luke 16:19–31; 1 Timothy 6:6–10, 17–19; James 2:1–9

The Bible discusses wealth, poverty, generosity, justice and the dangers of greed. Money can be used to meet needs and support others, but it should not become the measure of a person's worth. Christian teaching challenges discrimination against poor people and encourages generosity, contentment, honest work and responsible stewardship.

- Wealth can provide resources, but it does not guarantee wisdom, happiness or spiritual maturity.
- Greed is an excessive desire for wealth or possessions and can lead to injustice and neglect of others.
- The parable of the rich fool (Luke 12:13–21) warns against storing wealth without considering one's relationship with God and responsibility to others.
- The account of the rich man and Lazarus (Luke 16:19–31) challenges indifference to people in need.
- James 2 warns against favouritism based on wealth or social status.
- Responsible money management includes planning, saving, distinguishing needs from wants and avoiding dishonest gain.
- Generosity can involve money, time, skills, food, encouragement or practical assistance.

Think and apply: How can a learner practise generosity and responsible use of money without judging people by their income?

TOPICAL REVISION: APPLYING CHRISTIAN TEACHING

Use the following method when answering an application question: identify the issue, state a relevant Christian principle, support it with a Bible passage or teaching, propose a practical response and explain its likely effect.

A learner finds money in the classroom.

The learner should report it to the teacher or responsible office and avoid keeping it. Honesty and respect for another person's property are relevant Christian values.

A new learner is being excluded by classmates.

Learners can welcome the new learner, include them in group work and challenge unkind behaviour. Love of neighbour and the unity of the Christian community are relevant.

A group member does not contribute to a project.

The group should speak respectfully, identify barriers and agree on fair responsibilities. Diligence, patience and justice are relevant.

A family is affected by bereavement.

Offer sympathy, listen without judgement and provide practical support. The account of Jesus at Nain illustrates compassion for grieving people.

A learner is pressured to enter an unwanted relationship.

The learner should say no where safe, leave the situation and seek help from a trusted adult or safeguarding professional. Respect, consent and protection from harm are essential.

A community has families experiencing poverty.

Support should be offered respectfully, fairly and without humiliation. Christian teachings on generosity and justice challenge indifference and favouritism.

REVISION QUESTIONS AND SUGGESTED ANSWERS

5. 1. State four lessons Christians learn from the biblical account of work.

Suggested answer: Work is a responsibility; it should be honest and diligent; it can serve others and provide for needs; resources should be managed responsibly; and rest is important.

6. 2. Name five Christian moral values and explain two.

Suggested answer: Examples include love, honesty, justice, patience, forgiveness, humility, kindness and self-control. Explanations should show how a value guides action.

7. 3. Give two leadership lessons from David and two from Solomon.

Suggested answer: David's story highlights courage and accountability after wrongdoing. Solomon's story highlights the value of wisdom and the danger of divided loyalty or poor choices.

8. 4. What does Jesus' raising of the widow's son teach?

Suggested answer: It reveals Jesus' compassion and authority and encourages care for grieving and vulnerable people.

9. 5. Why did the Samaritan return to Jesus in Luke 17:11–19?

Suggested answer: He returned praising God and expressing gratitude after being healed.

10. 6. What is the main lesson of the friend at midnight parable?

Suggested answer: It teaches persistence in prayer and trust in God's goodness, while encouraging sincere prayer.

11. 7. Explain the meaning of being born again in John 3.

Suggested answer: It refers to spiritual renewal through the Spirit, not a second physical birth.

12. 8. State four activities of the early Church.

Suggested answer: Teaching, fellowship, breaking bread, prayer, sharing resources and supporting people in need.

13. 9. Why are spiritual gifts given according to 1 Corinthians 12?

Suggested answer: They are given for service and the common good of the Christian community, not for pride or competition.

14. 10. State four responsibilities of the Church.

Suggested answer: Worship, teaching, fellowship, service, witness and supporting people in need.

15. 11. Give five features of a healthy relationship.

Suggested answer: Respect, honesty, trust, communication, consent, appropriate boundaries and freedom from coercion or violence.

16. 12. State five responsibilities of parents or guardians.

Suggested answer: Providing food, shelter, healthcare, education, protection, love, guidance and appropriate discipline.

17. 13. Give four benefits of healthy leisure.

Suggested answer: Rest, physical fitness, creativity, friendship, stress reduction and development of talents.

18. 14. Explain three Christian teachings about wealth and poverty.

Suggested answer: Avoid greed; treat all people with dignity; share with those in need; manage resources responsibly; and reject favouritism.

19. 15. How can Christian values help resolve conflict?

Suggested answer: They encourage listening, truthfulness, patience, forgiveness, fairness, peaceful communication and responsible action.

BIBLE STUDY AND PERSONAL REFLECTION TEMPLATE

Study prompt	Learner's notes
Bible passage and context	
People and events in the passage	

Key teaching or Christian value
Evidence from the passage
How the teaching applies today
One action I can take
Question for further discussion

KEY BIBLE PASSAGE INDEX

- Work and creation: Genesis 1:26–31; Genesis 2:8–15; Colossians 3:23–24.
- Christian moral values: Galatians 5:22–23; Micah 6:8; Matthew 5:1–12; 1 Corinthians 13:4–7.
- David and Solomon: 1 Samuel 16–17; 2 Samuel 7; 2 Samuel 11–12; 1 Kings 3; 1 Kings 8; 1 Kings 11.
- Raising the widow's son: Luke 7:11–17.
- Ten people healed: Luke 17:11–19.
- Friend at midnight: Luke 11:5–13.
- Nicodemus: John 3:1–21.
- Jesus' ministry in Jerusalem: Mark 11–15; Luke 19; John 13.
- Early Church and Pentecost: Acts 1–2; Acts 4; Acts 6.
- Gifts of the Holy Spirit: 1 Corinthians 12; Romans 12; Ephesians 4; Galatians 5.
- Courtship and marriage: Genesis 2:18–25; 1 Corinthians 13:4–7; Ephesians 5:21–33.
- Responsible parenthood: Psalm 127; Proverbs 22:6; Ephesians 6:1–4; 1 Timothy 5:8.
- Leisure: Ecclesiastes 3:1–8; Mark 6:30–32; 1 Corinthians 10:31.
- Wealth, money and poverty: Proverbs 10:4; Luke 12:13–21; Luke 16:19–31; James 2:1–9.

Curriculum and editorial note

This is an original teacher-prepared learning resource for Grade 9 Christian Religious Education. It is not an official KICD publication. It follows the five broad strands identified in the Grade 9 CRE design: Creation, The Bible, Life and Ministry of Jesus Christ, The Church, and Christian Living Today. The topics and Bible references are provided as a study guide; confirm exact sub-strand titles, lesson allocation and school sequencing against the current KICD Grade 9 CRE Curriculum Design and the school's approved scheme of work.

The KICD Grade 9 CRE design summary and detailed content may show inconsistencies in some sub-strand lesson counts and numbering. Schools should follow the current official design and their approved scheme when allocating lessons.

Reference: Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD), CRE Grade 9 Curriculum Design (2024), available from the KICD curriculum designs portal.

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